

Who Pays and Who Decides: The Bridge Forward

谁承担，谁决定：通向下一程

Theme: 社会问题、经济与公共生活 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The ninth arc closed with a public **forum** in the center of town, where the **manner** of the meeting was as important as its content. “A **logical** argument will **appear** convincing and an **authentic** one will **appear true**,” the mayor said. “We must **avoid** the first and produce the second.” A **sorry** silence followed.

The **interested** parties were the **postman**, a **widower**, and a **resourceful bachelor** who had come to **advertise** a loan scheme. “There is a **misunderstanding** about what **visibility** means,” the **postman** said. “A **correct** figure that nobody can see is a **joke** with a **tear** in it.”

The **summit** of the evening was the **explanatory** brief, which was **adequate**, **applicable**, and mercifully short. “We can **detect** the **foreseeable** error only if we publish it,” the treasurer said. “An **exemplary** account is one that a **disputable** line can survive.”

The **argumentative** member provoked the only real dispute of the night. “A **purposeful** policy is not the same as a **manhood** contest,” she said. “An **erroneous** forecast is **harmless** if the correction arrives in time. An **apologetic** one is not.”

The **visibility** of the accounts, the **mercy** of a payment plan, and the **truthful** narration of the failure were the three things the meeting produced. “A **satisfactory** result would be a boring one,” Maya wrote. “That is what we should aim for.”

The **existence** of the scheme no longer depended on a single vote. A certain section of the town, a common type of household, and the strong support of the center had built something that could survive a change of council. The next arc would begin with a **loan**, a **summit**, and a question about who owns the record. The town, the section, the type, and the term: four words that a strong effect could build into a common center. We must add more to the account and cut less from the record. The political meeting would begin again in the winter, and the certain things would then be the full list and the strong evidence. The build of the scheme mattered more than its size. **Aside** from the **publicity**, the **fascinating** and **arguable** part was that an **observant** reader could check every line. They had published who pays; the harder page, who decides, was still blank.

中文翻译

第九段弧线以镇中心的一场公开论坛收尾，会上会议的方式与内容同样重要。“合乎逻辑的论证会显得有说服力，而真实的那种会显得真实，”市长说，“我们必须避免前者，产出后者。”随之而来的是一阵遗憾的沉默。

利益相关方是那位邮递员、一位鳏夫，以及一位机智的单身汉，他是来宣传一套贷款方案的。“对可见性有个误解，”邮递员说，“一个没人看得见的正确数字，是一个带泪的笑话。”

当晚的高峰是那份说明性摘要，它充分、可适用，而且幸运地简短。“只有把它公布出来，我们才能发现那个可预见的错误，”司库说，“一份示范性的账目，是那种一条有争议的行目也能挺过去的账目。”

那位好辩的成员挑起了当晚唯一真正的争论。“一项有目的的政策不等于一场男子气概的比赛，”她说，“一个错误的预报如果纠正及时就是无害的。一个忙着道歉的预报不是。”

账目的可见性、还款方案的仁慈，以及对失败如实的叙述，是这次会议产出的三样东西。“一个令人满意的结果会是无聊的，”曼雅写道，“那才是我们该瞄准的。”

这套方案的存在不再取决于一次表决。镇上某个特定的部分、某一类常见的家庭，以及中心地带强有力的支持，已经建起了某种能挺过议会更替的东西。下一段弧线将以一笔贷款、一场峰会，以及一个关于谁拥有记录的问题开始。那个镇、那个区段、那种类型，以及那个期限：四个词，一种强效果可以把它们建成一个共同的中心。我们必须给账目增加更多，而从记录里削减更少。政治会议会在冬天重新开始，而到那时确定的东西会是完整的清单和强有力的证据。这套方案的构建比它的规模更要紧。除了那点宣传之外，迷人的、可争辩的一点是：一位细心的读者能核对每一行。他们已经公布了谁付钱；而更难的那一页——谁来决定——仍然是空白的。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
appear ə'piə POS: vi	vi. 出现, 显得, 来到; [法] 出庭, 到案, 出现 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. come into sight or view; v. be issued or published; v. seem to be true, probable, or apparent; v. come into b...
true tru: POS: a	a. 真实的, 正确的, 忠诚的, 可靠的, 纯粹的, 正式的; n. 真实, 准确; adv. 真实地, 准确地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. proper alignment; the property possessed by something that is in correct or proper alignment; v. make level...
avoid ə'void POS: vt	vt. 避免, 防止, 撤消; [法] 避免, 回避, 躲开 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. stay clear from; keep away from; keep out of the way of someone or something; v. refrain from doing somethi...
sorry 'sɒri POS: a	a. 难过的, 悲哀的, 遗憾的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a feeling or expressing regret or sorrow or a sense of loss over something done or undone; s bad; unfortunate; ...
interested 'intrɪstɪd POS: a	a. 感兴趣的; [法] 有利害关系的, 有股份的, 偏私的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having or showing interest; especially curiosity or fascination or concern
manner 'mænə POS: n	n. 样子, 礼貌, 风格; [法] 方式, 方法, 样式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. how something is done or how it happens; n. a way of acting or behaving; n. a kind
existence ɪg'zɪstəns POS: n	n. 存在, 生存; [法] 存在, 存在状态, 实体 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the state or fact of existing; n everything that exists anywhere
loan ləʊn POS: n	n. 贷款, 借出; v. 借, 供应货款, 借给 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the temporary provision of money (usually at interest)
correct ke'rekt POS: a	a. 正确的, 合适的; vt. 改正, 订正 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make right or correct; v. treat a defect; a. free from error; especially conforming to fact or truth; s. soci...
tear tiə, tə POS: n	n. 泪滴, 眼泪, 撕, 扯, 裂缝, 激怒, 飞奔; vi. 流泪, 撕破, 赶快, 飞奔, 被撕破; vt. 撕裂, 戳破, 拉掉, 撕... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a drop of the clear salty saline solution secreted by the lacrimal glands; n. the act of tearing; v. separat...
aside ə'saɪd POS: n	n. 小声说的话, 旁白; adv. 在一边, 离开, 另外 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a line spoken by an actor to the audience but not intended for others on the stage; r. on or to one side; r. ...
joke dʒəʊk POS: n	n. 笑话, 玩笑, 笑柄; v. 开玩笑, 取笑, 作弄 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a humorous anecdote or remark intended to provoke laughter; n. a triviality not to be taken seriously; v. te...
adequate 'ædɪkwət POS: a	a. 适当的, 足够的; [法] 胜任的, 适当的, 充分的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having the requisite qualities or resources to meet a task; s. sufficient for the purpose; s. about average; ...
detect dɪ'tekt POS: vt	vt. 发现, 察觉, 探测; [法] 发现, 查明, 探测 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. discover or determine the existence, presence, or fact of
summit 'sʌmɪt POS: n	n. 顶点, 最高阶层, 最高级会议; a. 政府首脑的, 最高级的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a meeting of heads of governments; v. reach the summit (of a mountain)
publicity pʌb'lɪsɪti POS: n	n. 名声, 宣传, 公开场合; [经] 宣传, 广告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being open to public view
logical 'lɒdʒɪkəl POS: a	a. 合乎逻辑的, 合理的; [法] 逻辑的, 符合逻辑的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. capable of or reflecting the capability for correct and valid reasoning
satisfactory 'sætɪs'fæktəri POS: a	a. 满意的, 赎罪的; [法] 令人满意的, 令当事人满意的, 充分的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. giving satisfaction; s. meeting requirements
provoke prə'vəʊk POS: vt	vt. 激怒, 惹起, 诱导; [法] 刺激, 煽动, 激怒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. evoke or provoke to appear or occur; v. provide the needed stimulus for
forum 'fɔ:rem POS: n	n. 论坛, 公开讨论的广场, 法庭, 讨论会; [法] 讨论会, 专题讨论, 公共论坛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a public meeting or assembly for open discussion; n. a public facility to meet for open discussion
fascinating 'fæsnɪeɪtɪŋ POS: a	a. 迷人的, 吸引人的, 使人神魂颠倒的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v cause to be interested or curious; v to render motionless, as with a fixed stare or by arousing terror or aw...
advertise 'ædvətaɪz POS: vt	vt. 做广告, 通知, 公布; vi. 做广告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. call attention to; v. make publicity for; try to sell (a product)

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
applicable 'æplɪkəbl POS: a	a. 合适的, 可应用的; [法] 适用的, 适应的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. capable of being applied; having relevance
mercy 'mɜ:si POS: n	n. 仁慈, 宽恕, 慈悲, 怜悯, 幸运; [法] 权宜处置权, 决定权, 宽恕 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something for which to be thankful; n. alleviation of distress; showing great kindness toward the distressed
authentic ə:'θentɪk POS: a	a. 可靠的, 可信的, 真正的; [法] 被认证的, 确认的, 可信的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. conforming to fact and therefore worthy of belief; s. not counterfeit or copied
bachelor 'bætʃələ POS: n	n. 单身汉, 学士; [法] 学士, 单身汉 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a man who has never been married; v. lead a bachelor's existence
misunderstanding 'mɪsʌndə'stændɪŋ POS: n	n. 误会, 误解; [法] 误解, 误会, 不和 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n putting the wrong interpretation on; n an understanding of something that is not correct; v interpret in the...
harmless 'hɑ:mɪs POS: a	a. 无害处的, 未受损害的, 无辜的, 无恶意的; [法] 无害的, 无恶意的, 无损害的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. not causing or capable of causing harm
visibility 'vɪzɪ'bɪlɪti POS: n	n. 可见性, 能见度, 能见距离; [计] 可见性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. quality or fact or degree of being visible; perceptible by the eye or obvious to the eye; n. degree of expo...
explanatory ɪk'splænətəri POS: a	a. 说明的, 解释的, 辩明的; [法] 解释的, 说明的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. serving or intended to explain or make clear
foreseeable 'fɔ:'si:əbl POS: a	a. 可预知的, 能预测的; [法] 可预见的, 可预料的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. capable of being anticipated
exemplary ɪg'zempləri POS: a	a. 可仿效的, 可做模范的, 惩戒性的, 示范的; [法] 惩罚性的, 警戒性的, 示范的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. worthy of imitation
truthful 'tru:θfʊl POS: a	a. 说真话的, 诚实的, 真实的, 如实的; [法] 真实的, 说实话的, 诚实的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. expressing or given to expressing the truth; s. conforming to truth
postman 'pəʊstmən POS: n	n. 邮递员; [法] 邮递员, 理财法庭的高级律师 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a man who delivers the mail
purposeful 'pɜ:pəsʃʊl POS: a	a. 有目的的; [法] 有意图的, 有目的的, 故意的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. serving as or indicating the existence of a purpose or goal; s. having meaning through having an aim
manhood 'mænɦʊd POS: n	n. 成年, 勇气, 男儿; [法] 成年身分, 成年, 男子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being a man; manly qualities; n. the status of being a man
erroneous ɪ'reʊniəs POS: a	a. 错误的, 不正确的; [法] 错误的, 不正确的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. containing or characterized by error
apologetic ə.pələ'dʒetɪk POS: a	a. 道歉的, 急于认错的, 辩护的; [法] 辩护的, 辩解的, 道歉的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. offering or expressing apology
widower 'wɪdəʊə POS: n	n. 鳏夫; [法] 鳏夫 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a man whose wife is dead especially one who has not remarried
resourceful rɪ'sɔ:sʃʊl POS: a	a. 资源丰富的, 策略的, 机智的; [法] 资源丰富的, 善于随机应变的, 足智多谋的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having inner resources; adroit or imaginative
arguable 'ɑ:gjuəbl POS: a	a. 可辩论的, 可论证的; [法] 可争辩的, 可论证的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. capable of being supported by argument; s. open to argument or debate
observant əb'zə:vənt POS: a	a. 严格遵守...的, 留心的, 当心的, 观察力敏锐的, 注意观察的; [法] 注意的, 留心的, 严格遵守的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. paying close attention especially to details; s. quick to notice; showing quick and keen perception
argumentative 'ɑ:gju'mentetɪv POS: a	a. 好辩的, 引起争论的, 论证式的; [法] 争辩的, 辩论的, 有争议的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. given to or characterized by argument
disputable dɪs'pjʊ:təbl POS: a	a. 有讨论余地的, 未确定的; [法] 可争论的, 可置疑的, 可反驳的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s capable of being disproved; s open to argument or debate